

A

Things we make, do and take

Common mistakes

We use all three of these common verbs with particular nouns. These word partners (collocations) are often different in other languages, so look at them carefully.

I've **made** a **mistake**.

She **took** a **photo** of me this morning.

They **made** a big **effort** to finish the work.

Sometimes two different verbs are possible.

I'm just going to **take/have** a **shower**.

Take/Have a **look** at these pictures.

We must **make/take** a **decision**.

I'm afraid I haven't **done** my **homework**.

I haven't **done** the **housework** yet.

The children are **making** too much **noise**.

I'm **doing/taking** a Spanish **course** next month.

I don't **do/take** much **exercise**.

B

Make

Make can mean 'to cause something to happen or cause a particular state'.

I like Boris – he **makes me** laugh.

It **made them** angry when Karen refused to help with the washing-up.

Make can also mean 'to force someone to do something'.

My parents **made me** do my homework when I was a child.

The police **made us** wait outside the main gates.

If you **make friends with** someone, you get to know them and like them.

I **made friends with** a couple of guys from Canada when I was on holiday.

If you **make up your mind**, you decide something.

He's **made up his mind** to leave work at the end of next month.

C

Do

We use **do** to describe a general action when we don't know what it is, or there's no noun.

What shall we **do** this afternoon?

Don't just stand there, **do** something.

If you **do your hair / make-up**, you make it look nice.

I'll just **do my hair**, then we can go out.

If you **do your best**, you try as hard as possible.

I'm not a good student, but I always **do my best**.

D

Take

Take can mean to:

- remove something from a place/person, e.g. I **took** the key **out of** my pocket.
- remove something without permission, e.g. Someone has **taken** my pen.
- accept something, e.g. Did he **take** the job they offered him? Do they **take** credit cards there?
- write something down, e.g. I **took** notes during the meeting. The man **took** my name and address.
- wear a particular size in clothes, e.g. I **take** size 43 shoes.

If you **take it / things easy**, you relax and don't do very much.

I'll **take things easy** today.

If you **take a break**, you stop work and rest for a short period.

Let's **take a** ten-minute **break**.